

LORD IRWIN IN BOMB OUTRAGE

ATTEMPT TO WRECK SPECIAL TRAIN NEAR DELHI

COACH DAMAGED

EXPLOSIVE FIRED BY CONCEALED CABLE

A DELIBERATE attempt to wreck the Viceregal special train, in which Lord and Lady Irwin were returning after their tour in South India, was made yesterday near New Delhi.

A bomb, skilfully hidded between the rails six miles from New Delhi exploded as the train passed the spot at 50 miles an hour and badly damaged one of the coaches but the Viceroy's saloon escaped.

The bomb was fired by means of a concealed cable attached to a battery which was found later about 300 yards from the railway line.

Lord Irwin was under the impression that the noise of the explosion was due to fog signals—there was a heavy mist at the time—and was unaware of the occurrence until informed of the outrage by his military secretary.

The train continued its journey and arrived punctually. Neither Lord Irwin nor Lady Irwin appeared perturbed, and the Viceroy drove immediately to his new House where he replied to the Municipality's welcome address.

The Labour Cabinet met specially yesterday, and it was assumed that the meeting was occasioned by the news of the outrage.

VICEROY UNPERTURBED

(From Our Special Correspondent.)

New Delhi, Dec. 23.

It was exactly 17 years ago that a bomb was thrown at Lord Hardinge when he made his State entry into Delhi, and to-day, by some mysterious coincidence an attempt to wreck Lord Irwin's special train, fortunately with little success, was made on an equally important occasion.

Lord Irwin was returning from a strenuous tour in South India, and New Delhi, in spite of a thick fog and cold, was expecting to see His Excellency make his first entry into the new Viceregal House. It was

Lord Irwin. Lady Irwin.

for this ceremony that His Excellency suspended his usual annual visit to Calcutta for Christmas, but the deep designs of some miscreants marred the happiness of the occasion to some extent.

For just close to Nizamuddin Railway Station, six miles from New Delhi, the plot had been hatched, and arrangements to blow up the train had been made with considerable skill and secrecy.

Nothing happened when the pilot engine passed Nizamuddin and was approaching New Delhi. A few minutes later, however, when the special train was passing at a normal speed of 50 miles an hour, there was a sudden explosion.

Authentic information is to the effect that the bomb machine was buried between the ballast between the rails and was fired by means of a concealed cable attached to a small battery which was subsequently discovered at a distance of about 300 yards from the railway line. Whether did it seems to have been with amazing skill and care so as not to be suspected by those in the first engine, although he was largely helped by the presence of the exceptionally thick fog.

SLEEPER SMASHED

As unluckily the bomb exploded at the middle of the fourth coach from the engine, while the Viceroy's saloon was two coaches further behind.

TRAIN SHAKEN

VICEROY AND LADY IRWIN UNAWARE OF OUTRAGE

New Delhi, Dec. 23.

Inquiries at the Viceroy's House show that the explosion was thought to be fog signals until the whole train shook violently.

Both the Viceroy and Lady Irwin were not aware of the accident until Colonel Harvey, the military secretary, reported the outrage.

The Viceroy, on alighting at New Delhi, inspected the damage.

The explosion was heard by New Delhi residents, but all mistook it for the usual guns heralding the Viceroy's arrival.

Considerable resentment is felt at the outrage, and the Delhi police and the Central C. I. D. have taken up the investigation.

The Chief Commissioner, Sir John Thompson, was at his office immediately afterwards, examining the details of the outrage with his officers.

NO CASUALTIES

EXPLOSION BETWEEN THIRD AND FOURTH CARRIAGES

The official notification of the outrage is contained in a telegram from the District Traffic Superintendent, N. W. Railway, as follows:—

"On the 23rd instant, at about 7.40 hours, an attempt was made to derail the Viceregal special train between Hazrat Nizamuddin and New Delhi by means of a charge of explosive under the track. Apparently the charge exploded between the third and fourth vehicles behind the engine, and although one rail was broken and minor damages caused to the third and fourth vehicles, the train continued on its journey and arrived at New Delhi to scheduled time. There were no casualties."

CABINET MEETING

MR. BENN RECALLED FROM ABERDEEN

London, Dec. 23.

The bomb outrage at Delhi has profoundly shocked London. The *Evening Standard* in an editorial note emphasises that British policy in India will not be deflected in the slightest by deeds of violence.

The Cabinet met specially to-day. It was assumed that the meeting was occasioned by the news from India, especially in view of Mr. Wedgwood Benn's sudden recall from Aberdeen.

ARRESTS AT LAHORE

BOMB OUTRAGE INVESTIGATION

Attempt to Cause Special Train to Plunge from High Embankment.

MESSAGES TO THE VICEROY

Eight arrests have been made by the police at Lahore in connection with the bomb outrage on the Viceroy's train. Three of the persons were arrested in Congress circles. Several house searches were also carried out by the police in the same city.

Further details of the outrage indicate how it was intended that the explosive was fired by an electric spark from an old form of battery, about a furlong away, which was connected with the line by insulated wire. It was obviously the plotters' intention to blow up the track and cause the train to plunge over the embankment.

News of the outrage was communicated by cable to His Majesty and this message was read in the House of Commons. Lord Irwin after referring to the attempt to wreck his train hopes His Majesty will not be disturbed by exaggerated reports.

The outrage has shocked London and messages of horror at the outrage have been sent to the Viceroy expressing sympathy among others, by Sir John Simon, Mr. Wedgwood and Mr. Baldwin. Meetings have been also held in various parts of India condemning the outrage.

Lord Irwin's Cable to His Majesty

DETAILS OF THE BOMB OUTRAGE.

DAMAGE TO TRAIN.

(From our special correspondent.)

NEW DELHI, December 23.

This has been a day of mixed sensations in Delhi, for the arrival of Their Excellencies the Viceroy and Lady Irwin in their new capital was marred by a dastardly outrage aimed at them; but, thanks to their almost miraculous escape, their entry into their beautiful new house took place as arranged with simple but picturesque ceremony. The outrage was connected with an electric bomb and a variety of reports about it have throughout the day been chasing one another. The following are the correct details as verified in regard to the bomb by police investigation. Their Excellencies' special train, preceded by a pilot engine, was due at New Delhi Station at 7-40 o'clock. A white mist, so thick that one could not see more than about ten yards, covered the ground. The train ran into this some distance outside Delhi and, for that reason was programmed to do. Between two and three miles from New Delhi Station, the line runs along the top of a high embankment crossing low ground between the river Jumna and the Purana Kila. The latter lies at the extreme eastern end of the central vista which proceeds straight across the centre of New Delhi from the Purana Kila to the newly built Viceroy's House. As the train passed behind the Purana Kila, those travelling in it heard a dull heavy report. Most of them thought nothing of it, for the mist was so apparent to everybody and the noise was taken for that of a fog signal. But there were some who knew that something more serious had happened, for the explosion took place directly under the entrance platform at the front end of the third coach in the train and the floor of the platform was blown up by the force of it.

COACH DAMAGED.

I have seen the damaged portion of the train; the floor has been through it a hole big enough perhaps for a man to get through; the boards around it are half pushed up inwards, as though with a battering ram; the steel supports which bore them are twisted all out of shape. The platform is at the entrance to a corridor coach which accommodates the Viceroy's English

EIGHT ARRESTS AT LAHORE.

THREE IN CONGRESS

(From our own correspondent.)

LAHORE, December 23.

The police held several searches this morning in connection with the bomb outrage on the special. Eight arrests were made morning. The names of persons are:—

Ram Kishen, President, Bharat Sabha.

Johan Illahi, an active worker in same Sabha.

Virendra son of Mahta proprietor, *Pratap*, a local

Kirun Chandar Dutt, Jatindra Nath Dutt, Secretary Lahore, as a result of

Sukh Dev, Congress v

Milkhi Ram.

Dhanvanti an Ayurvedic practitioner and an act Naa Jiwan Bharat Sabha

Abdul Malik, another same Sabha.

Of these Kiran Chandra and Sukh Dev were at Congress Camp on Tuesday The remaining persons last night.

It is said that Viceroy's train were handed over to Congress authorities at Lahore after taking them in

MESSAGE TO

ATTEMPT TO WR

LONDON, Dec

In the House of Commons Mr. Baldwin, replying to Mr. Simon, regarding the outrage, Mr. Wedgwood Benn read the message from the King:—

"I regret that Your Majesty that made this morning's train by exploding as we were approaching Delhi. Luckily no harm was done to any of us realised what had happened. I hope Your Majesty will not be disturbed by exaggerated reports."

Mr. Benn added that he was expressing

▲ **The bombing of** Lord Irwin's special train to New Delhi was covered extensively by the media. His tenure as Viceroy (1926–31) saw tumultuous times in modern Indian history.

A matter of sabotage

World War I (1914–18) slowed things down considerably, but railways would once again become central to the revolutionaries, with the passing of the Rowlatt Acts in 1919. The Acts looked to curb the civil liberties of Indians under special circumstances – some political cases could now be tried without juries, and certain prisoners could be jailed